

1970–1979

STAGE, DANCE, AND PARTY

The 1970s was about fantasy, escapism, and new fabrics, expressed in exuberant colours and prints and experimentation with style. Big stars were shining bright in outfits that went all out to impress. Chart-toppers and celebrities donned the finest fabrics to create luxurious looks that were a photographer's dream. Classy, full-length figure-huggers battled with short, sparkly halternecks and hot pants for centre stage. Lycra, satin, and velvet were the fabrics of choice, while feathers and sequins added extra sparkle. Designers went to town creating show stoppers, knowing that an outfit could make or break an up-and-coming artist. As innovative styles were worn, new fashion icons were born. Young people copied their idols, putting on the glitz in cheaper imitations.

AGE OF ACCESSORIES

Dresses and suits were set off by a variety of on-trend accessories. With the penchant for luxurious soft fabrics, many were made of suede, velvet, and fake fur, including hats and handbags. Belts were also tightening their fashion grip as unusual chain versions cinched in waists and accentuated outfits.



Baker boy cap



Hot pants and chain belt

Long-strapped shoulder bags in materials such as sleek satins, crushed velvets, and coloured leather were a must-have for young women. Art-deco inspired bags were styled with ornate decorations and artificial jewels. Straps ranged from narrow chains to chunky leather, while buckle and zip fasteners finished the look.

Gold bag by
Judith Leiber

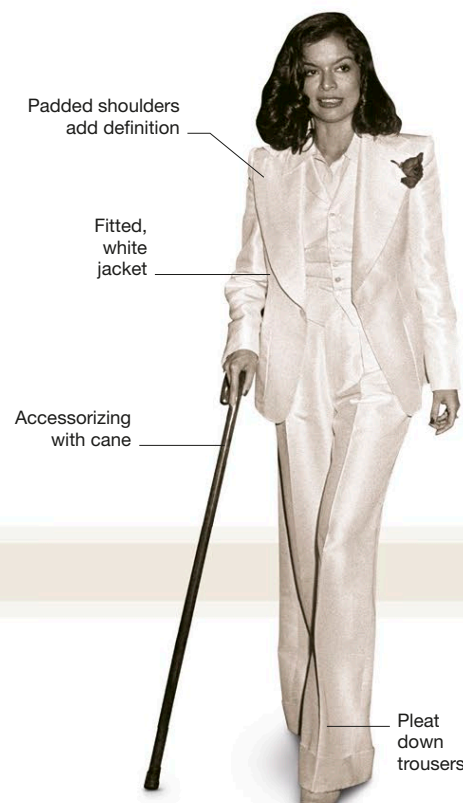
Decorative bag



Fancy feathers Theatrical influences turned some clothing into costumes. British designer Carol McNicoll here mixes fine fabrics, using feathers to showcase the shoulders, flared satin to add originality, and a colourful waistcoat to break up the black.

Lettuce-leaf
hemFull-length,
green,
pleated skirt

Rainbow dress African-American designer Stephen Burrows's passion for both strong colours and comfortable, jersey-style materials are seen in this evening dress from 1973. Bands of colours are seamed carefully around a white, oval centre.

Padded shoulders
add definitionFitted,
white
jacketAccessorizing
with canePleat
down
trousers

All white In 1974 Bianca Jagger, then wife of Rolling Stones front man Mick Jagger, wore a dazzling white satin trouser suit by US designer Roy Halston Frowick. Halston-inspired outfits were popular at Studio 54 in New York and parties in 1970s London.